PRIORITY 24 OF 33 · SCORE 2.5

USAID (winding down)

USAID's programs were moved into the State Department in 2025, but the agency still spent $11.7B in FY2026 closing out awards. Close-out is a risky period: advances not returned, unsupported final costs, and assets left with partners. The work belongs with State going forward; the specific USAID task is a close-out recovery screen.

INVESTIGATIONS WE PROPOSE

USAID-1 Terminated awards with obligations far above outlays (unreturned advances). **First prototype.**

USAID-2 Partners with OIG findings now funded by State.

EXPOSURE

- $11.7B in outlays and $18.5B in budgetary resources in FY2026, mostly legacy awards.
- USAID OIG historically reported diversion of aid and partner fraud in conflict zones.

PUBLIC DATA WE USE

- **USAspending and ForeignAssistance.gov:** awards, obligations and outlays by partner, including terminated awards.
- **SAM.gov** exclusions; USAID OIG reports.

HOW WE DETECT IT

1. **Unliquidated advances:** terminated awards where obligations far exceed outlays, ranked for recovery follow-up.
2. **Partner history:** implementers with prior OIG findings now receiving State awards.

FIRST PROTOTYPE

A close-out table of terminated USAID awards with remaining balances and partner risk flags.

SCORECARD

Fraud savings identified
Pending

Phase 1 window
Weeks 11–12
Jan 25, 2027 to Feb 5, 2027

Workstream
Shared screens

FY2026 outlays
$11.7B · budget rank 23

Leads go to
State and USAID OIG

WHY PRIORITY 24

Exposure	●●
Public data	●●●
SBA method fit	●●●
Actionability	●●

OUR REVIEW, DELIVERED WEEK 12

Table of terminated awards with obligations far above outlays (possible unreturned advances) and partners with prior OIG findings now receiving State awards.

Every lead goes to an Inspector General or DOJ as a referral package with sources and caveats. Nothing is published.

WHAT WE ASK OF USAID

Phase 2 data: Partner financial reports, beneficiary lists, borrower KYC.

What it enables: Diversion and ghost beneficiaries; borrower ownership.

Access route: Each OIG.

LIMITS

Close-out financial status is not fully public.

SOURCES

- ForeignAssistance.gov
- USAspending agency profiles (FY2026 outlays)

Scores and plans are our judgment from public sources. Risk indicators are leads for Inspectors General or DOJ, not accusations.

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